

able and practical. He believes the government has already taken some proactive steps on the policy front, but the primary support needed from the government at this stage is addressing challenges related to connections, which are the biggest

hurdles for any EV company.

The company currently operates approximately 500 charging stations, covering cities and highways. EarthtronEV has recently launched operations in Kolkata, with one charging station in Howrah and another in

progress. In Delhi, they strategically position charging stations throughout the city, ensuring a robust network. Now, they are looking at a slightly longer-term goal, aiming to have 10,000 chargers by 2027.

—Nitisha Dubey

2 PAROVA'S MADE-TO-ORDER DRONES AND UNIQUE DESIGNS

Building on the power of R&D, Parova Technologies offers customised design and development services for drones

With a unique logo of a flying fish, Andhra Pradesh-based startup Parova Technologies offers drone customisation and development services for startups, college clubs, and university students.

Founder Rohith Dacharla began his journey in the fourth year of his software engineering course from a small lab in 2017. Unable to pursue pilot training due to financial constraints, Dacharla, harnessed his passion for aerial vehicles to establish Parova Technologies in 2019 for end-to-end research and development services. Co-founder Venkata Kamesh started contributing his expertise in avionics and subsystems in 2023 to complement Dacharla's strengths in industrial design and innovation.

The startup covers everything from conceptualisation to fabrication and assembly of drones based on client specifications and budget constraints, for agricultural use, political rallies, or defence applications. "We design drones based on their ideas, considering initial requirements, and provide the option of choosing between affordable imported components or entirely made-in-India products," says Dacharla.

The startup also offers consultancy services for drone design and



Model of Parova's Bajrang

development, guiding the entire process—design, testing, training, and licensing assistance, depending on various categories or stages of development of a product. In case of a complete product, they provide procurement assistance, gather technical details, offer consultation on potential upgrades and extra charges on the imports and assembly for the same. For a company with a semi-formed idea, the company helps to understand requirements, components, and pricing, discussing the option of importing versus local production.

Highlighting the R&D capabilities as their strength, Dacharla recognises the importance of originality in design instead of merely replicating designs from other countries. Prompted by the idea to come up with a unique design for propellers of one of their clients, Dacharla came up with a design that exhibited higher efficiency than conventional propellers by introducing ridges on the propellers, guiding

airflow in a specific direction.

"While the concept is straightforward and can be found in many research articles, its implementation on a propeller resulted in a propulsion efficiency boost of over 100%, and could potentially revolutionise commercial aviation. Currently, discussions are underway with the HAL team in Bengaluru to explore testing possibilities, as our in-house capabilities may not be sufficient for comprehensive testing," he explains.

With customisation and design services being the primary business model, Dacharla sees this as a way to fund and strengthen his R&D capabilities to establish a network of commercial logistic aircraft for drones, for sustainable and on-demand logistics in India. This is where he explains the meaning of the flying fish logo,

"The flying fish, despite being a fish, can fly above the water surface to avoid predators and maintain stability. We aim to replicate this concept by building a network of